

Glossary

Acid A reactive chemical that contains hydrogen.

Acidic Having the properties of an acid.

Alkali A chemical that reacts easily with acids and water.

Alkaline Having the properties of an alkali.

Allotrope A physical form of an element where the atoms are arranged differently.

Alloy A substance made by mixing two or more elements together, of which at least one is a metal.

Alpha particle A cluster of two protons and two neutrons emitted by some radioactive elements.

Ammonite A type of shellfish that died out millions of years ago.

Anaesthetic A substance given to patients to stop them from feeling pain.

Antiseptic A substance that kills different disease-causing germs.

Artificial element An element produced in a laboratory.

Atmosphere Layers of gases around a body in space.

Atom The smallest unit of an element that contains protons, neutrons, and electrons.

Atomic mass The total number of protons and neutrons in an atom of an element.

Atomic number The number of protons in an atom of an element.

Beta particle An electron given out by an atom during radioactivity.

Boiling point The temperature at which a liquid turns into a gas.

Bond The attraction between atoms that holds them together in an element or a compound.

Brass An alloy of copper and zinc.

Brittle The property of a hard, inflexible solid that makes it break into pieces when hit.

Bronze An alloy of copper and tin.

Cellulose A substance containing carbon that is found in all plants, especially in wood.

Chemistry The scientific study of the properties and reactions of elements.

Combustion A reaction involving oxygen that produces fire and heat.

Compound A substance made of the atoms of two or more elements.

Conductor A substance that lets electricity and heat pass through it.

Corrosion A reaction that attacks a solid object, mostly made of a metal, and weakens it.

Decay The process of radioactive atoms breaking apart.

Electrolysis A process that uses electricity to split a compound into its elements.

Electron A negatively charged particle moving in a shell around the nucleus of an atom.

Electron shell One of the layers surrounding an atom's nucleus that contains electrons.

Element A substance that cannot be broken down any further into simpler ingredients.

Evaporation The process in which a liquid turns to gas at a temperature below its boiling point.

Extraction The process of separating a substance from its source.

Fossils The remains of ancient life forms found in rocks.

Fuel cell A device that generates electricity using a chemical reaction.

Fuel rod A supply of nuclear fuel used to make electricity in a nuclear reactor.

Gamma ray A very high-energy form of radiation released from radioactive atoms.